David Gareth Werren (Known as Gareth)

Chief Platform Officer | Lending & Fintech Software Platforms | AI-Enabled Engineering

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Summary

Technology leader and software architect with 19 years' experience, 17 of them in financial services, currently Chief Platform Officer at Fignum. I lead the architecture, engineering, AI strategy and day-to-day operations for Origin and Adapt, Fignum's loan origination and servicing platforms for specialist lenders, working closely with clients from pre-sales through to delivery.

Having built and led a team of around 30 across the UK, Portugal and Hungary, I combine hands-on AI adoption in a regulated environment with a track record of winning board support through clear, evidence-based proposals.

Key Achievements

Board-level influence: Persuaded the Bluestone Group board to invest in building a new origination platform instead of enhancing the existing home-grown system, modelling and presenting cost, timeline and risk for each option side by side. That platform is now Origin, Fignum's flagship product, live with mortgage and motor lenders.

Shared platform architecture: Architected Evolve, the core platform that powers both loan origination (Origin) and loan servicing (Adapt). Evolve underpins our rapid prototyping and delivery of bespoke client solutions.

AI transformation: Led the adoption of Claude Code and GitHub Copilot through a champions network, showcases and dedicated experimentation time. Built team-wide AI tooling including internal MCP servers, shared skill definitions and knowledge. We estimate a 2x to 10x increase in delivery capacity, depending on the type of task, whilst maintaining quality.

AI-powered client prototyping: Introduced rapid prototyping sessions for prospective clients and new implementations. They have become a strong pre-sales tool and cut new implementation requirements gathering to around a week while significantly improving quality.

Team leadership: Built and led a team of teams in the UK with outsourced partners in Portugal and Hungary of around 30 engineers and testers, delivering multi-million-pound programmes while supporting existing systems.

Skills

Leadership and strategy: Board and senior stakeholder management • Distributed teams • Vendor and partner management • Pre-sales and RFPs

Architecture and engineering: Software architecture • Engineering standards and CI/CD

AI: AI strategy and adoption • In-product agentic AI • MCP • Claude Code • GitHub Copilot

Technology: Distributed systems • Kafka • Kubernetes • C# • SQL • Azure DevOps • GitHub

Financial services: Lending (mortgage and motor) • Pensions • Trading and risk

Experience

Chief Platform Officer (2025 – Current), Head of Development (2020 – 2025), Fignum, Cambridge

Configurable loan origination and servicing platforms, part of the Bluestone Group. Reporting to the CEO, accountable for the software platform, architecture, engineering, delivery and AI strategy.

Platform and Product

- Origin, a configurable multi-asset loan origination system with 30+ third-party integrations. Live with mortgage and motor clients, with a multi-asset client in progress.
- Adapt, configurable loan servicing with a double-entry finance engine, collections workflow and bank reconciliation, building on Origin's Evolve core platform. First client under way.
- Paycada, SME payments platform integrating with Xero and Stripe, sharing many components from the Origin and Adapt core platform.
- Defined AI product capabilities within Origin and Adapt, combining the best of build (in-product agentic capabilities) and buy (e.g. bank statement data extraction).
- Led adoption of AI across the software delivery lifecycle (requirements, development, testing, documentation) plus custom tooling including MCP servers, monitoring and triage tools.

Commercial and Operations

- Led technical pre-sales demos and RFP responses and owned budgets for major client and platform projects.
- Set engineering standards and CI/CD practices, allowing the team to release changes quickly and confidently.
- Worked with IT and Compliance on Fignum's obligations as an FCA material supplier, including security and resilience.
- Managed legacy in-house products including card payments and telephony systems, focusing on service quality, compliance and support.

Lead Developer, River and Mercantile Solutions, London 2014 – 2020

Fiduciary and advisory services for pension funds. Now Schroders Solutions.

- Technical leadership across the team of 9 in-house developers, led CI/CD implementation.
- Designed and built interactive trade modelling for securities and currency hedging along with an online portal for clients and consultants to access up-to-date scheme information.

Software Engineer, Base 4, Cambridge 2012 – 2014

Biotech company developing brand new systems for DNA sequencing.

- Designed and built high-performance lab control, data capture and analysis systems, reducing the time taken to run experiments from days to hours and increasing the data quality.

Software Developer to Lead Architect, SunGard Adaptiv, Cambridge 2007 – 2012

Market and credit risk solutions for the financial sector. Now part of FIS.

- Grew from building the initial POC for a brand-new enterprise product (Adaptiv Risk Cube) to being the lead architect, leading client POCs and implementations, and managing a team.

Education: MEng, Computer Systems Engineering, University of Bristol 2001 – 2005